



THE WOLVERINE GROUP

Federal Acquisition Analytics

SBA Size Standard Rulemaking — Docket SBA-2026-0199

Companion methodology docket SBA-2026-0265 — comments close September 21, 2026

User Guide

NAICS Size Standard Impact Tool

Everything needed to run the tool, from entering your NAICS codes to filing a comment.

IN ONE PARAGRAPH.

You open the tool in a web browser and type the NAICS codes you compete in. The federal award data is already loaded, so there is nothing to download first. The tool finds the companies whose small-business status would change if a size standard moves, shows how each of them has been winning work, and produces a spreadsheet, a verification form, and a draft comment to SBA. If you need a scope the prepared data does not cover, you can still supply your own file from USAspending instead. Nothing is installed and no account is required.

Where to find it	
The tool	https://jaimegracia2821.github.io/SBA-Size-Standard-Tool/
Source and documentation	https://github.com/jaimegracia2821/SBA-Size-Standard-Tool

PART 1 • WHAT THE TOOL DOES, AND WHAT IT DOES NOT

When SBA changes a size standard, some companies that are too large to count as small today become small, and a smaller number move the other way. This tool finds the companies



whose status would change, using public federal contract data, and characterizes how they compete today.

It works on any NAICS code and any pair of thresholds. It is pre-loaded for the August 2026 proposed rule affecting management consulting, but nothing about the analysis is tied to that rule.

THE LIMITATION THAT GOVERNS EVERYTHING ELSE.

The tool measures federal prime contract dollars. Size standards are based on total company receipts from all sources over five fiscal years, with affiliates included (13 CFR 121.104). Commercial revenue, subcontract revenue, and affiliate revenue are not in this data at all.

A company can therefore look small in this output and be well over the threshold in fact. What you get is a ranked list of candidates worth investigating. It is not a determination of who is small and must never be presented as one.

PART 2 • WHAT YOU NEED BEFORE YOU START

For most people, one thing: the NAICS codes you compete in. The award data and the size standards come with the tool.

There are two ways to get data into the analysis. The prepared dataset is the normal route. Your own USAspending extract is there for the cases the prepared data does not cover.



The award data is prepared by MakeGov, using Tango, their unified API for U.S. federal contracting data. Tango draws on SAM.gov, USAspending, FPDS, DSBS, GSA eLibrary, Grants.gov, GAO bid protests, and agency forecasts, and resolves entities across UEI and DUNS identifiers so that one company reads as one company rather than several records that happen to share a name. Entity resolution is the hard part of this analysis, and it is why you don't have to download anything.

Tango unifies SAM.gov, USAspending, FPDS, DSBS, GSA eLibrary, Grants.gov, GAO bid protests, and agency forecasts behind a single API key. Built for developers, priced for builders. To learn more, visit their website: makegov.com.



WHAT THE PREPARED DATASET CARRIES.

Federal award data rolled up from contracting offices to parent companies, plus the current and proposed size standard for each code it covers, read at the same time as the award data. Its scope, fiscal-year window and reporting-delay cutoff are fixed when it is built, and the tool shows all three on screen when the data loads.

B.1 The normal route: type your codes

On the first screen, enter the codes separated by commas — for example 541611, 541612, 541613 — and press Continue. Only the codes you type are sent. No file is uploaded and nothing about you is transmitted.

The tool reports how many parent companies it found, which codes and fiscal years the dataset covers, when it was built, and the floor below which small companies are not included. Read that line before going on; it tells you exactly what you are analyzing.

SOME CODES CANNOT BE ANALYZED AT ALL.

Certain NAICS codes measure size by number of employees rather than revenue, and the proposed rule moves some codes from one basis to the other. Award data contains no headcount, so there is no honest answer to give. The tool names those codes on the scope screen and asks you to uncheck them rather than producing a figure it cannot stand behind.

B.2 The alternative: your own USAspending extract

Use this when you need a scope, a date range, or a reporting-delay cutoff the prepared dataset does not cover. It is behind the line reading "Prefer to use your own USAspending extract?" on the first screen. The file is read inside your browser and never uploaded.

Go to USAspending.gov, then Award Search, then Advanced Search. Use Download and choose Custom Award Data. Set these filters:

Filter	What to choose
Award type	Contracts
File type	Prime Award Transactions
NAICS	The code or codes you are analyzing



Filter	What to choose
Date range	Five full federal fiscal years

THE FILE TYPE MATTERS MORE THAN ANYTHING ELSE ON THAT PAGE.

The summaries file gives one row per award. The tool needs one row per contract action with its own date, because it sorts money by when it was obligated. Choose the wrong file and the results are wrong in ways that are hard to notice. The tool checks and will tell you if you picked the summaries.

A federal fiscal year runs October 1 through September 30, so five full years ending with FY2025 means 2020-10-01 through 2025-09-30. Five years is not arbitrary — it is the averaging period the regulation uses. A shorter window answers a different question, and the tool will warn you if your file falls short.

You will get a ZIP. Hand over the whole ZIP without unpacking it; the tool picks the right file from inside. These files are large — one NAICS code across five years came to roughly 240,000 rows — so use a desktop browser rather than a phone.

THE TWO ROUTES MEASURE SIZE DIFFERENTLY, AND THE PREPARED ONE MEASURES IT BETTER.

The prepared dataset knows each company's whole federal book, so it applies the size test the way the regulation does: total receipts from all sources, not just the codes you are looking at.

An extract you download has already been filtered to your codes before it reaches the browser, so the tool can only measure size within that scope. That understates every diversified contractor. Each row of the workbook records which basis was used, so you can always tell. Expect the two routes to produce different cohorts for the same codes.

B.3 The two thresholds

Every analysis needs the current size standard for your codes and the proposed one. On the prepared route both arrive with the dataset, sourced and dated. On the upload route the tool fills them in where it carries them; where it does not, it stops and names the code rather than guessing, and asks you to enter the figure together with where you read it.



WHY THE TOOL REFUSES TO GUESS.

Codes that look closely related often carry different standards. Within the management consulting group alone the current figures range from \$19.0 million to \$29.0 million. A wrong threshold does not produce an obvious error; it produces a plausible-looking list of the wrong companies. Every standard loaded into the tool must carry a stated source, and entries without one are rejected.

The proposed rule publishes its size standards table as page images rather than text, so those figures are transcribed rather than machine-read. Confirm them against the notice before you publish or file anything.

PART 3 • RUNNING THE ANALYSIS

Open the tool in a desktop browser and work through four steps down the left side. There is nothing to install and no account to create.

- Enter your NAICS codes. Type them separated by commas and press Continue. The tool reports how many parent companies it found and which codes and years the dataset covers. Check that against what you meant to analyze — it is the cheapest error to catch. If you are using your own extract instead, open the section below the entry box and drop the ZIP in there.
- Set scope and standards. Confirm the thresholds and the settings below. On the prepared route the scope, the fiscal-year window and the reporting-delay cutoff are fixed by the dataset and shown rather than editable, because they were decided when it was built.
- Run. A progress bar tracks the work. Keep the tab open.
- Review the results and download what you need.

WHAT LEAVES YOUR COMPUTER, AND WHAT DOES NOT.

On the prepared route the only thing sent is the list of NAICS codes you type. Nothing about you or your company is transmitted, and no file is uploaded.

On the upload route the file is read inside the browser and nothing is sent at all, which is why the tool can be used with sensitive pipeline data.

Either way, the analysis runs on your own machine and closing the tab discards everything. Nobody but you holds a copy of what you analyzed or what you concluded.



C.1 The settings that change the answer

Setting	Default	What it controls
NAICS codes	The codes you entered	On the upload route, uncheck any code you do not want included.
Current standard	Supplied with the data	What counts as small today, per code.
Proposed standard	Supplied with the data	The figure under the rule being analyzed.
Fiscal years to average	Five	Matches 13 CFR 121.104. Fixed on the prepared route.
Defense reporting delay	Cut off 90 days back	Defense actions publish 90 days late. Fixed on the prepared route.
Combine company identifiers	On	Merges companies appearing under several identifiers.

LEAVE THE COMBINING SWITCH ON.

Large firms operate under many separate identifiers. Without combining them their revenue fragments and they appear inside the band when their combined total is well above it. In one real run a major consulting firm showed up at \$140 million under one identifier; combined it was \$740 million and nowhere near the band. Every merge is listed in the workbook for review.

PART 4 • READING THE RESULTS

On screen you get a summary, a sanity check against SBA's own published count where one exists, and a table of the companies in the band. Three things are worth reading closely.

- Unrestricted share. The portion of a company's work won through open competition. A company at or near 100 percent has never had to win a set-aside and would be entering that pool for the first time. This is usually the most significant finding in a run.
- Confidence rating. LOW means many identifiers, unusually concentrated awards, or other conditions that make the estimate unreliable. The largest firms are usually the least reliable, because they carry the most revenue this data cannot see.
- The sanity check. Where SBA has published its own count for a code, the tool compares against it. Your cohort should be a small subset. If it is larger, something is wrong with company identification and you should stop.



D.1 What you can download

Download	What it holds
Full workbook (.xlsx)	Seven tabs. Start_Here carries the run parameters and the disclaimer; Validation carries the checks; then the cohort, the competition split, the reporting-lag ledger, code diagnostics, and the list of combined companies
Cohort list (.csv)	Just the companies in the band, for a CRM or another tool
Verification checklist (.docx)	A sign-off form covering every figure the run produced
Comment draft (.docx)	An unbranded draft comment to SBA, described in section F

Read the Validation tab before using any number from the workbook. It records the settings the run used and flags anything that looks wrong.

PART 5 • VERIFYING THE FIGURES

One bad figure causes everything around it to be discounted. The checklist exists to catch that before it reaches a client or a docket.

It lists every figure the run produced with a checkbox, a space for the value you independently read from the source, and a space for initials. It closes with pre-publication statements and two signature lines.

TWO PEOPLE MUST SIGN, AND THEY MUST BE DIFFERENT PEOPLE.

The reviewer enters the value they read from the source document, not the value already printed on the form. A figure that does not match is a stop, because it means either the run was misread or the source was. Self-verification defeats the purpose of the exercise.

PART 6 • DRAFTING A COMMENT TO SBA

Agencies must respond to significant comments. Sentiment is not significant; a position backed by data is. The tool drafts a comment built around your own figures and produces an unbranded Word document with no header, footer, or styling, so it pastes cleanly into your own letterhead.



THE TOOL TAKES NO POSITION ON THE RULE.

The analysis engine measures; it does not argue. You choose your position — oppose the increase, support it, support it with modifications, or take no position and submit the data alone — and the argument sections are written to whichever you pick. Section 3, which reports what the award record shows, is identical under every position, because the measurement does not change with your view of it.

Choose your position, then enter your company type, receipts, employees, NAICS code, years in the federal market, and any set-aside figure from your own records. The draft runs to roughly 700 to 1,000 words depending on the position, across five sections: your standing and stake; the treatment of the 45 industries where SBA's own analysis supported a decrease; what the award record shows in your market; the fact that the methodology and the standards derived from it share one comment period; and what you ask SBA to do, written as regulatory text it could adopt.

It runs entirely in your browser. No account, no sign-in, nothing sent anywhere.

READ IT, THEN REWRITE SECTIONS 2 AND 4 IN YOUR OWN WORDS.

Those two sections argue from the rulemaking record, so every filer choosing the same position will produce similar text, and agencies discount identical submissions as a form campaign. Sections 1, 3 and 5 are built from your own figures and are already specific to you. The comment is filed under your name and states your position, not the position of whoever built the tool. Do not file anything you would not have written.

The tool independently scans the draft and flags any number that does not trace to your authorized figures. Anything flagged appears on screen and as a notice at the top of the document so it cannot be filed by accident. If you would rather have an AI rewrite the draft in your own voice, copy the prompt — it already contains your figures and the instruction to cite nothing else.

Comments on Docket SBA-2026-0199 close September 21, 2026. Check the docket for current status before relying on that date.



PART 7 • CAUTIONS BEFORE YOU PUBLISH ANYTHING

- Confirm every threshold against the 13 CFR 121.201 table. Some figures shipped with the tool came from secondary sources and are labeled as such in the output.
- Name the averaging window whenever you publish a count. A different window produces a materially different list of companies even when the total barely moves.
- Review the list of combined companies. Name matching is a heuristic and two unrelated firms can share a name stem. Check the short names and any group combining four or more identifiers.
- Carry the confidence ratings through to anything client-facing.
- Record the run date. The spending database backfills continuously, so the same query run two months apart returns different answers for the same period. Undated output cannot be reproduced or defended.
- Check the Diagnostics tab on any new NAICS code. Codes the tool has not seen are set aside and reported rather than silently misfiled.

A PROPOSAL IS NOT THE LAW.

Current size standards govern until a final rule takes effect. Nothing from this tool should be used to advise anyone to change a SAM representation, re-certify, or alter a bid strategy on the assumption that a proposed standard will be adopted as drafted. Proposed rules are routinely changed or withdrawn.

PART 8 • KNOWN LIMITATIONS

- Employee-based size standards cannot be analyzed. Spending data contains no headcount.
- Subcontract revenue is absent, which understates firms working largely as subcontractors.
- Obligations are recorded at award while revenue is earned over the performance period, so year-to-year figures are lumpier than actual revenue.
- Company identification depends on the parent identifier in the source data, which is incomplete, and on name matching, which is imperfect.
- The prepared dataset has its scope, its fiscal-year window and its reporting-delay cutoff fixed when it is built. To analyze anything outside that, use your own extract.



- The prepared dataset excludes companies below a dollar floor over the window; the floor is stated on screen when the data loads.
- An extract you download yourself measures size only within the codes you pulled, because that is all the file contains. The prepared route measures against the whole federal book, as the regulation does.
- Very large files are limited by your computer's memory rather than by the tool.
- Two enrichment fields are placeholders pending a connection to the federal registration system.

PART 9 • IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

What you see	What it means
That dataset could not be loaded	The prepared data service did not answer. Try again, or use your own USAspending extract from the section below the entry box.
A code you entered is not in the results	The dataset does not cover it, or it is measured by employee count. The scope screen names any code it cannot analyze.
No transactions file in that ZIP	You downloaded award summaries. Re-download choosing Prime Award Transactions.
Missing required columns	The file is not a transactions extract. Check the download options and try again.
A warning that your data covers fewer than five years	Your date range is short. The missing years count as zero and will understate every company. Re-download with a wider range.
Cannot run, size standards unresolved	The NAICS code has no threshold on file yet. It must be sourced from 13 CFR 121.201 and loaded before the run.
Unmapped codes on the Diagnostics tab	Values the tool has not seen. Check the dollars involved before relying on the competition split.
The sanity check reports a failure	The cohort is larger than the population it should be a subset of. Usually a company identification problem.
Downloads do nothing	The tool is running inside an embedded frame, which browsers block downloads from. Open it at its own web address instead, and the downloads will work normally.
A 404 or page-not-found error	The web address is wrong. It is case-sensitive — check the capital letters.



What you see	What it means
Figures flagged in the comment draft	A number in the draft does not trace to your authorized list. Source it or remove it before filing.

Award data prepared by MakeGov, Inc. using the Tango API — <https://www.makegov.com>. Tango unifies SAM.gov, USAspending, FPDS, DSBS, GSA eLibrary, Grants.gov and GAO bid protests behind one interface, with entity resolution across UEI and DUNS identifiers. The tool is built and maintained by The Wolverine Group, Inc. MakeGov is not responsible for the analysis, the conclusions drawn from it, or any comment filed using it.

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